

# Open Source is Powering the Blockchain Revolution

Blockchain is a disruptive technology that is changing the world in a variety of ways. Cryptocurrencies are the most obvious example. This article compares and contrasts this technique with open source, another revolutionary technology that has transformed software development. We'll look at how these systems differ in their approaches and qualities, as well as why open source development is the key to rapid blockchain adoption.



In 1991, a group of researchers and scientists set out to create a technique that would allow them to timestamp documents in an immutable format so that these could not be tampered with or backdated. They came up with a solution that was simple and straightforward. Each timestamp would be saved in a block. A timestamp, a unique hash value to identify the timestamp, and the hash value of the previous block holding the previous timestamp would be included in each block. These blocks would be programmed to be immutable, making it nearly impossible to modify their values. Figure 1 gives a graphic representation of this.

The researchers had no idea that they were laying the groundwork for a technology that might one day revolutionise a variety of sectors.

Satoshi Nakamoto (a person or group of persons) founded Bitcoin in 2008 using blockchain technology. The aim was to change the way we use money. Bitcoin

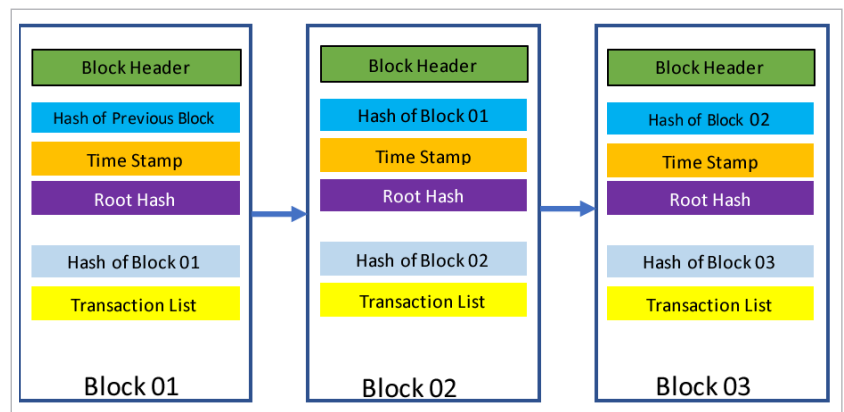


Figure 1: Basic structure of a blockchain (Courtesy: IEEE Internet Initiative)